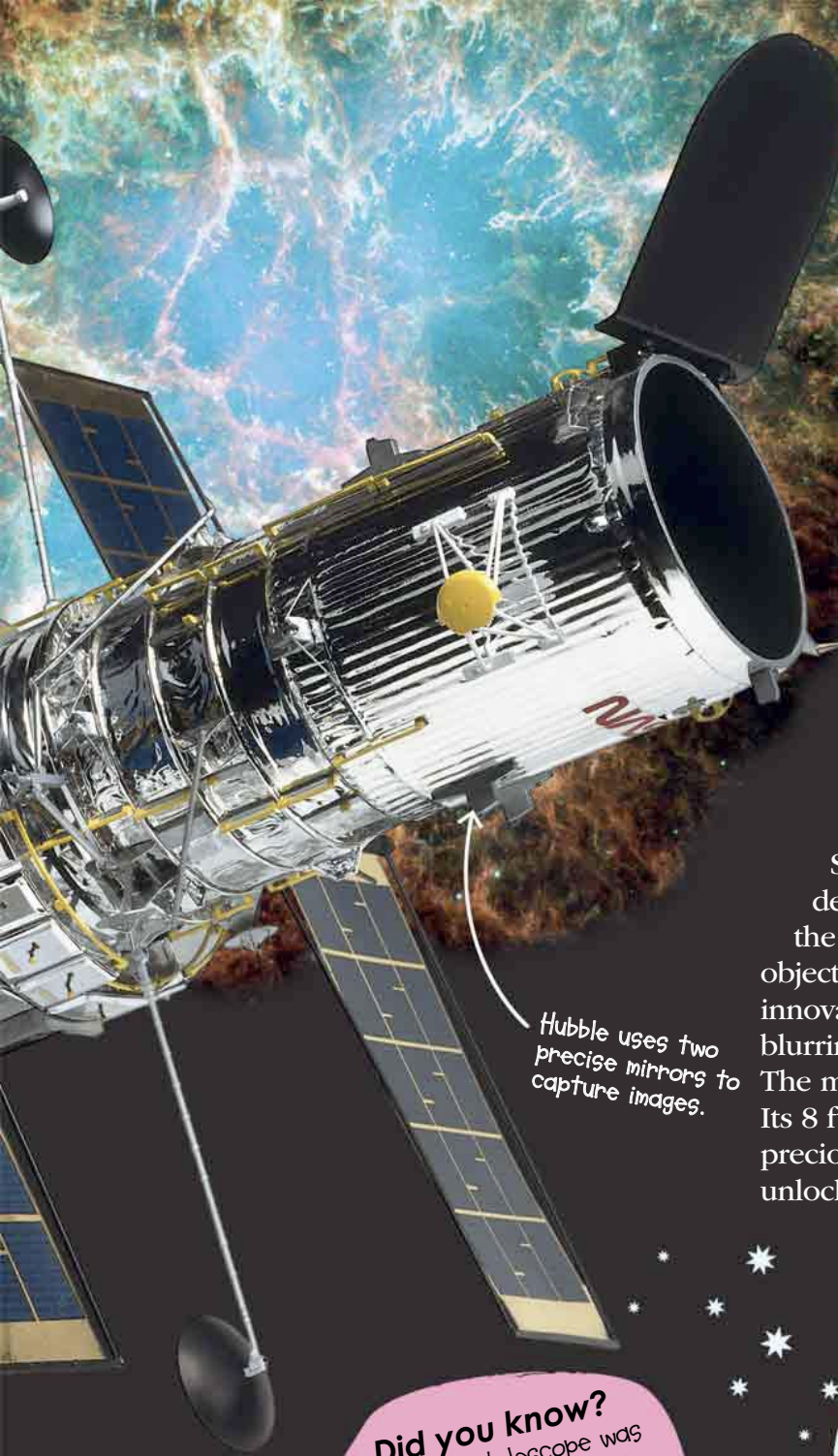
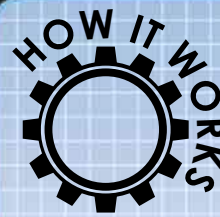
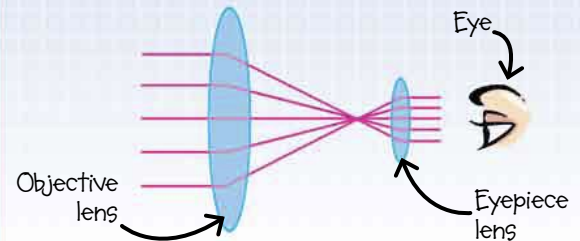




Hubble uses two precise mirrors to capture images.



A refracting telescope (like Lippershey's and Galileo's) is a tube with an objective lens at one end. Light from a distant object is bent as it passes through this lens and focused into a magnified image. An eyepiece lens at the other end of the tube then magnifies the image even further. Many telescopes, including Hubble, use mirrors to help collect light—these are called reflecting telescopes.



Space telescopes

Since Galileo, there have been many developments in telescope technology, including the use of **MIRRORS** in telescopes to bring distant objects closer still. Perhaps the most exciting innovation is the launching of telescopes past the blurring effects of Earth's atmosphere and into space. The most famous is the **Hubble Space Telescope**. Its 8 ft (2.4 m) wide main mirror has collected precious information from space, and helped us unlock some of the *secrets of the Universe*.

Did you know?

The Hubble telescope was launched in 1990, and is still in operation, thanks to five repair missions by spacewalking astronauts.

Launched in 2003, the **SPITZER SPACE TELESCOPE** detects heat energy radiated by objects in space.



Astronomy's most important invention has shown us our Solar System and beyond, and continues to help us understand how the Universe works.



The **VERY LARGE ARRAY** in New Mexico is a radio observatory. Its **27 ANTENNAS**, each 82 ft (25 m) across, scan the skies for radio waves.

